"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."

DANIEL J COMP

AN INTERACTIVE - AI GUIDED - SELF-MASTERY EXPEDITION FOR LEAVING

SCOTOMAVILLE



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Filmed on location (tour map):
Pacific Northwest: Bellingham, WA; Semiahmoo, Blaine, WA; Stanwood, WA; Maryhill Memorial, WA; White Pass WA; Chelan WA; Plymouth WA; Mount Hood Meadows, OR; White River Snow Park, Mt. Hood, OR; Hood River, OR; Bend, OR; Three Mile Canyon, OR; **California, Nevada:** BLM, Susanville, CA; Oroville, CA; Washoe Lake, NV; Rye Patch, NV; Pine Flat Lake, CA; Lake Cahuilla La Quinta, CA; Barstow, CA; French Camp, Tom's Place, CA; **Idaho, Montana, Wyoming**: Coeur d'Alene, ID; Twin Falls ID; Murtough Lake, ID; 3 Island Crossing, ID; Scotch Pines GC, ID; Rigby, ID; Missoula MT; Billings, MT; Clark Canyon Res, MT; Rocky Point, Belle Fourche, MT; Casper WY; **Utah, Colorado, New Mexico, Arizona:** Piute Reservoir, UT; Jordanelle Reservoir, UT; Bald Mountain, UT; Bonneville Salt Flats, UT; Little Salt Lake UT; Sand Hollow, Hurricane, UT; Purgatory Resort, CO; Longmont, CO; Chatfield State Park, Littleton, CO; Grand Junction, CO; Albuquerque, NM; Bottomless Lakes, Roswell, NM; Caballo Lake, NM; Elephant Butte, NM; VLA Radio Observatory, NM; Lake Pleasant, AZ; Homolovi Ruins, AZ; Scottsdale, AZ; BLM, Tusayan AZ; BLM, Quartzsite, AZ; Potato Patch CG, Jerome, AZ; Porter Spring, Roosevelt, AZ; Apache Gold, San Carlos, AZ; Roper Lake State Park, AZ; Fool Hollow, Show Low, AZ; **Kansas, Nebraska, South Dakota:**; Wichita KS; Lake Kanopolis, KS; Wilson Lake, KS; Lewis & Clark Rec Area, Yankton, SD; Platte Creek Rec Area, SD; Badlands National Park, SD; Lake Mcconaughy NE; **Oklahoma, Texas:** Oklahoma City, OK; Bear Creek Cove, OK; Lake Texoma, OK/TX; Tulsa, OK; Lawton, OK; Wichita Falls, TX; Lake Lavon, TX; Littlefield, TX; Van Horn, TX; Palmetto S.P., TX; League City, TX; Yegua Creek, Somerville, TX; Waco, TX; Lake Whitney, TX; Canyon Lake, TX; Clear Lake, Princeton, TX; Cedar Hill State Park, TX;

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*The desire to understand ourselves, to unravel the mystery of **WIDWID**—Why I Do What I Do—connects us all. It's a question I have pursued by cycling across America on three inspiring Journeys with a Purpose.*

*After decades of mishaps and 50,000 miles dragging an Airstream I no longer view **Know Thyself** as a luxury or a full-out competition with AI. With a team of like-minded thinkers (a self-defined minyan) empowered by a super-reasoning engine, I am becoming a thought leader and a sage celebrating the later execution phases of my Personal Everest with the help of a digital Sherpa.*

***Remember your first journey?** I was hopeful yet unprepared, like a Fiat 500 strapped with a useless burden on my back. At first, this image represented my idealistic youthful exploration, a journey both underpowered and naive. Recently, I discovered a double meaning in the word 'Fiat' itself. Beyond the name of a car, it refers to a decree, an authoritative commandment. In my journey, these were the self-imposed life commandments from false conclusions I formed of misspoken judgments that had shaped my worldview. It was as if the very mascot of my exploration challenged me to escape the self-tyranny of my thinking. W.H. Murray noted we experience '**all manner of unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no man could have dreamt would have come his way.**' The discovery of the Fiat's symbolic richness was one such unforeseen incident that deepened my journey.*

Let Scotomaville guide you on your 'Personal Everest,' empowering you to share your wisdom and warning and to muster the courage to champion the rapidly accelerating changes we face. Join me by turning the life you inherited into the outcomes you design.

April 27, 2024



AUTHORS + ABSTRACT



AUTHORS CURATORS

Daniel believes; ***"The Greatest Expedition you will ever undertake is the journey to self-understanding, for the real voyage of discovery consists not in seeking new lands, but in seeing with new eyes."*** *He is a respected husband, father, entrepreneur, and Navy Veteran. He's demonstrated decades of sacrificial commitment to human achievement using core principles, perseverance, and resourcefulness.*

Angelina is the wife of a highly functioning Asperger (me) and co-founder with me of Intelligent Netware. She is twice awarded by the U.S. S.B.A. In 2004, she sustained a TBI five days before filming for the Apprentice III. Angelina is the Founder of Wellness by Choice and a mom with a mission - bent on educating and empowering the masses on how to live smarter and healthier.

SCOTOMAVILLE ABSTRACT

- ***BACKGROUND - WWDWWD***

Most people respond to chaos and stress with coping mechanisms, amygdala hijackings, and reactive behavior. For some of us, curiosity dominates. We want to know ***"Why We Do What We Do."*** *and are committed to exploring the unknown... to 'Know Thyself'. The Author cycled across America three times asking this.*

The pandemic has challenged us with hardships, losses, setbacks, missed opportunities, and personal drama. [1] Americans are weary of rapidly accelerating change.

We are flooded with messaging that games our biological and psychological bents [2]. Emotions easily overwhelm our reasoning to control our actions. We're further conflicted by being 100% wrong 50% of the time. [3] [4]

We're hoodwinked and bamboozled by tech, media, and popular narratives using trickery, flattery, and omission. [5] The adage to 'Know Thyself' is no longer a luxury. It's become a full-out competition with supercomputers pointed at our brains. [6]

■ *METHODS - IMPARTATION*

The Scotomaville program deploys the unique IMPARTATION METHODOLOGY, designed to guide participants in self-reflection and personal growth through video modeling. This methodology unfolds in a structured manner:

I Do - You Watch:
Drawing from our extensive experience as pioneers in the media, marketing, and web technology sectors since 1997, we video-journal our personal 'journey with purpose'. Through these recordings, we share and demonstrate 15 invaluable mental tools, tests, and insights that enable resilience in facing challenges. Participants, armed with just a smartphone, can emulate our perseverance as we navigate adversities such as Traumatic Brain Injury, PTSD, and more.

We Do - We Watch:
The program is more than just watching; it's engaging. Fifty-three episodes are complemented by a comprehensive 400+ page guide, enriched with opportunities for online discussions. Subscribers benefit from peer support, mentoring, and personalized guidance. Furthermore, the extensive digital reach, spanning over 4500 affiliated websites, allows for participant and sponsor recognition.

You Do - I Watch:
The Scotomaville journey doesn't end with passive learning. Upcoming offerings include transformative base camp summits, private retreats, and expeditions for leaders. With the program's licensed platform, certified leaders can guide individuals and groups, encouraging them to tread the transformative path we demonstrate.

■ *FINDINGS - SELF-GAMING*

By climbing a 'Personal Everest' and testing for oneself, the claims of W.H. Murray, and the Authors that Expeditions are filled with ***"unforeseen incidents and meetings and material assistance, which no one could have dreamt would have come their way"*** *(9) you can develop clarity, stability, healing, and successes by gaming your biases.*

Self-mastery begins with awareness of one's physical and mental self. When combined with understanding, support, and discipline, incremental character change transforms one's beliefs, attitudes, and behavior.

SCOTOMAVILLE reveals the intricate interdependence between our gut and brain, demonstrating how sleep patterns and stress levels influence our choices. By emphasizing the perils of tackling challenges solo and showcasing actionable insights and examples, the program empowers individuals to recognize and navigate their inherent cognitive biases.

■ *CONCLUSION - PERSONAL EVEREST*

A 'Personal Everest' is a journey with a purpose. ***"But at least learn your inability... and ask the remedy for it. Learn of those who have been bound like you... These are people who know the way which you would follow, and who are cured of an ill of which you would be cured. Follow the way by which they began..."***

Blaise Pascal - Pascals Wager (10)

A Personal Everest is a journey with a purpose. It is a self-defined expedition of personal development, with support and guidance from peers and the Author, and analysis by AI.

SCOTOMAVILLE is an unconventional and effective self-help model and platform with a convincing challenge: We can change our life experiences by gaming our own handicaps, strengthening alliances, challenging our shortcomings and changing our false beliefs by taking on our Personal Everest.

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(1) https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/33711676/

(2) https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC8402266/

(3) https://www.ted.com/talks/kathryn_schulz_on_being_wrong/transcript

(4) https://www.amazon.co.uk/Yossi-Yassour/e/B08XJNFCNK/

(5) https://www.humanetech.com/who-we-are#team

(6) https://www.wired.com/video/watch/yuval-harari-tristan-harris-humans-get-hacked

(7) https://intelligentnetware.com

(8) https://scotomaville.com/digital-locations

(9) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/W._H._Murray

(10) https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pascal%27s_wager

Scotoma's are hard to spot. They open the door for 'recommenders' to chase us with course-corrections toward the rocks. On the other hand, AI can stay ahead of most humans. Let's see how that goes.

VOLUME TWO

v2 EXPEDITION PRELUDE

"problems are complicated and we're 100% wrong 50% of the time. We Google and let Youtube confirm our beliefs: yep, it's too complicated for us to sort out... or is the scotoma that we don't want to make the effort?

2.00

What you wouldn't expect is how often we are 100% wrong.

Welcome to Volume Two of SCOTOMAVILLE! We're in a fabulous place called Purgatory. But, C.S. Lewis wrote that we can chose to leave. We don't have to stay here. Yea!

Volume One is about mental tools for self-awareness to get to self-understanding. From there, you can use discipline to change the trajectory of your experience in life.

An expedition is a 'journey with a purpose.' If the purpose is to transform what you've been handed into something better, then Volume Two will be a fabulous desert trek!

Hopeful Avoidance Fails

I've known a few people that have gone to seminars and workshops with the hope they'd get a bump up, a lift, an artificial boost to their self-awareness. In my experience, awareness does not come without great effort.



Our 20 watt brain is wired to quickly reach conclusions by finding familiar patterns. Do you see a smiley face in the door latch?



THE MANUFACTURER RECALLS ARE FOR MILLIONS OF FAULTY DOOR LATCHES. YEP, MY DOOR LATCH IS FAULTY.

You have to walk up that thing. (looking up the chair-lift hill) If you just get airlifted to the top of your Personal Everest, you're going to get edema. Your brain swells up, and you die on the mountain.

Psychological Scotoma Example: *Psychological scotomas are hard to find. They're usually right in front of us, often disguised as work. And you go down a long, windy path usually taking a short-cut away from critical thinking.*

Case in point: Last night.

Angelina: *Let me show you the problem. Watch the door - it's not latching. Look at that; it's not latching. You can't drive a car with an unlatched door because you'll fall out. Look right here.*

Daniel: *It's a $68,000 brand new Ford and, what did I do? I went online to discover articles: Ford's got 2.15 million vehicles in a door latch recall, 1.34 million truck door latch problems. There's a class-action suit that has been ongoing for years, and years, and years. Oh my gosh, it's just on and on and on.*

"WE DON'T SOLVE CHALLENGES WITH A 'CLEAN SLATE'. WE START FROM PREVIOUS CONCLUSIONS – HALF OF THEM WRONG."



OUR BRAINS ARE WIRED TO REC-OGNIZE PATTERNS, TO TAKE SHORTCUTS AND JUMP TO CON-CLUSIONS IN ORDER TO CREATE MEANING FROM CHAOS WITH THE AIM OF PROTECTING US FROM REAL OR IMAGINED DANGER.

forward to episode 2.12 on Self-care

So then I called the dealership to find out that we couldn't get the vehicle in until Monday because it's already Friday. And, after they look at it, it'll be seven to ten days to get the parts, and then it'll be three or four days in repair. Meaning it's two weeks from now before they can fix it. But then they look up my VIN, and they discover something shocking.

Your VIN is Invalid

Angelina: *It is almost August 2020. We purchased the truck in December 2019 and filled out all the paperwork, including the registration fees and taxes. We need our title. And we don't have our title, which means we can't fix our vehicle because we don't own it! And I've gone back and forth and back and forth between emails and phone calls and sending documents! Oh my! And right now, we have a door that won't latch but will swing open when Daniel drives, where I could fall out, but I won't because we aren't driving it.*



Daniel: *You've been very patient, waiting for them to do their paperwork - over and over.*

Angelina: *I'm not patient anymore. It's a safety issue, and it's a transportation issue!*

Daniel: *She has been patient. Less so for me. I've been scared to drive without license plates. Look at the back of the book! It says Sco oma! The printer rejected the book on three fix-it tickets because the spelling doesn't have the 't'! But driving without a valid license plate because the car is not registered? I have to be patient. COVID has everyone messed up.*

Angelina: *COVID is part of it, but then there's incompetence and poor customer service.*

"You might have had it a year, but you don't yet own the vehicle, so we can't do the repairs"



“scotoma!”

Look for what’s really going on

“Life is what happens between our plans.” Problem is, our plans are biased by what we believe is true - based in large part by digital recommendations.”



Daniel: *She’s always patient! If she’s triggered, then something is very off. I have some defuse time, asking where’s the scotoma? It can’t be this complex! Let’s look at the truck to show you what I discovered. I think through what I’ve read about the recalls and the latches freezing, and I think ‘wait a minute, let me see, now that I know the mechanics of the door, let me look at something...*

Angelina: *Yesterday, I had some mints when we took my daughter to the airport, and I put it back in here. And unbeknown to me...*

Daniel: *Here, where you store your things.*

Angelina: *Yeah, it’s where I store my stuff, but look at how easy the door pull is to flip it down. It’s effortless.*

Daniel: *What does that do?*

Angelina: *It keeps the door unlatched because that's what you pull on to open the door. That's why it won't latch, because of these! (picking up the mints) I have to stick the mints at the bottom, so I don't fall out of the car while you're driving - because of mints!*

Daniel: *Here's the takeaway for getting out of SCOTOMAVILLE. Use the tools in Volume One to solve problems and to mature rather than just age. I'll demonstrate this across Volume Two.*

Do you see Pattern Recognition?

If I believe things are always complicated then I jump right to a conclusion with my 20-watt brain. I find something familiar (a pattern). I match it up with experiences I've had (amygdalae), and jump to a 100% wrong conclusion!

However, I came to another point of view by taking diffuse time, letting the ideas cross-connect, and using triangulation. Tadaah!

Mints in The Latch Cubby

I take a moment to re-assess with a closer look. Why are mints in the latch cubby?

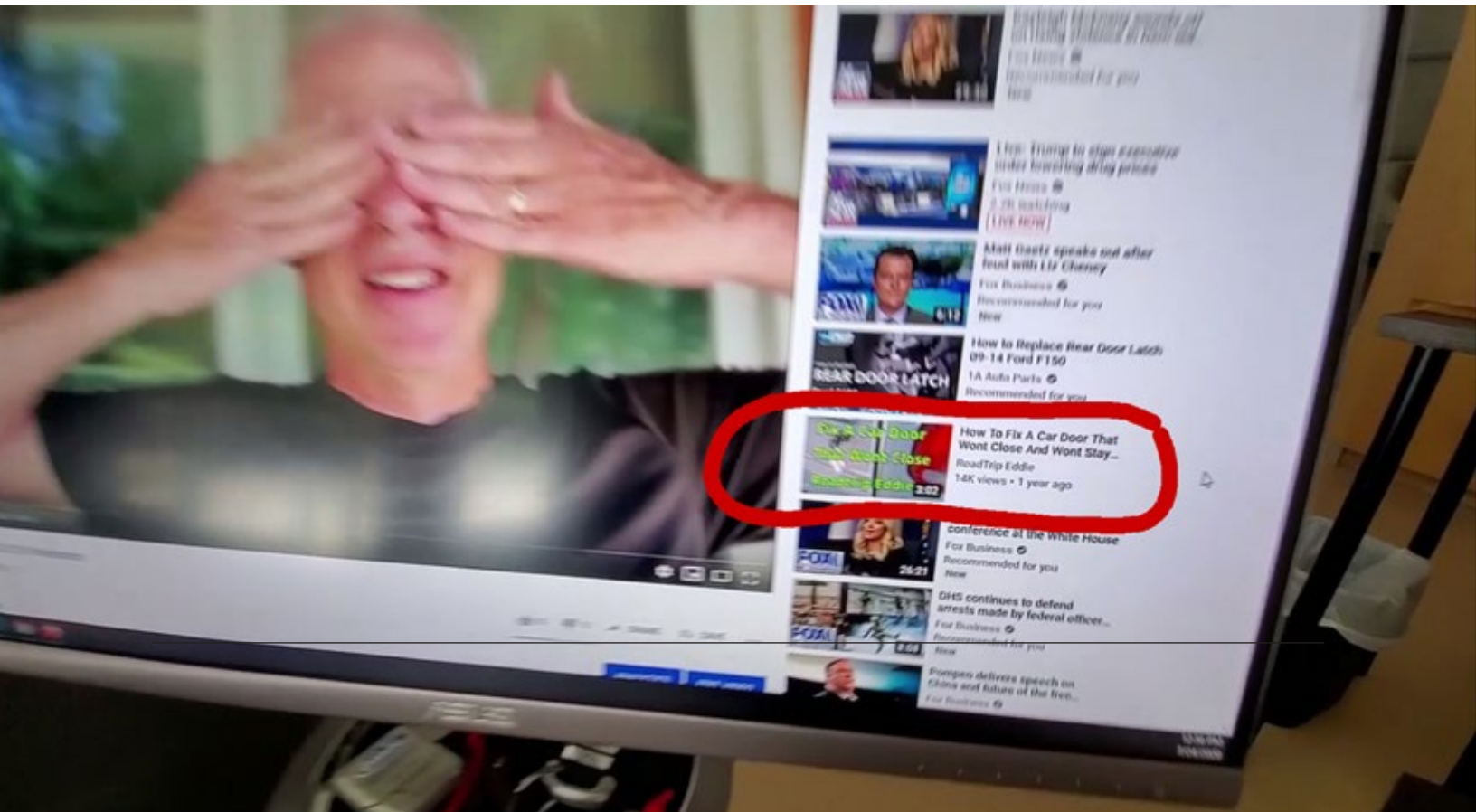
Although my fear is facing two weeks without a vehicle and a thousand dollars in costs, I practice advice from Marcus Aurelius. It turns out I've been gifted a challenge to overcome. *Doing so demonstrates that the mental tools of Volume One work.*

I'm pleased to be wrong half of the time. It liberates me to find the truth. I don't have to accept what I've been led to believe.

BONUS INSIGHT

I don't want you to miss this! I did some research on Google earlier. I'm finishing my to-do list and, now, on YouTube, in the sidebar... A.I. posing as a helpful recommender is now chasing me! See how this is all tied together?

Scotomas encourage A.I. to chase you!





CURVES AHEAD:
The journey to self-awareness seems to create its own weather - to obscure your confidence. Be ready.

*I want for you to become **more than self-aware**. I want you to **understand** why you do what you do. Better than that, I want for you **the discipline** to create a life for yourself that you weren't handed. To change things from what you inherited to what you desire.*

You can do that. I've done it.

We're starting V2 in the Pacific Northwest, heading to New Mexico to pick up our Airstream and from there journeying with purpose. I look forward to the Episodes to come, which I have not planned or storyboarded. I want to see how we handle the future events, the changes, the curves, the disruptions, the life that happens between our plans!

At the top of the results is a long-standing class-action lawsuit on similar door latches. Crap. I'm triggered.



WATCH

https://youtu.be/BFKHp5srevQ

Leaving Scotomaville includes a visit to Purgatory. C.S. Lewis wrote that we don't have to stay there. You should only discover a scotoma once. If you discover the same one thrice - then consider Lewis' allegory:

In C.S. Lewis's allegorical novel "The Great Divorce," purgatory is depicted as a sort of grey town where the inhabitants find themselves after death. This grey town is neither Hell nor Heaven but rather a place where people are stuck in a state of dissatisfaction and misery.

Lewis's concept of purgatory is unique in that it's not a place of punishment or purification, but rather a place of choice. The inhabitants of the grey town have the option to take a bus to the outskirts of Heaven, where they are met by spirits who encourage them to make the journey into Heaven, relinquishing their earthly desires, vices, and false selves.

The central theme here is that the inhabitants of purgatory are not sentenced to stay there; they are given a choice. They can choose to let go of the things that hold them back and ascend to Heaven, or they can choose to hold on to their earthly attachments and return to the grey town.

Many characters in the novel find the choice difficult, as letting go of their former selves and earthly attachments is painful and challenging. But Lewis emphasizes that the choice is always there, and it's never too late to grow.

The novel's portrayal of purgatory underscores Lewis's belief in the power of free will and the importance of personal responsibility in spiritual growth. It aligns with the Christian doctrine of salvation through grace, with the understanding that individuals must actively choose to accept that grace.

In connecting with your philosophy, Daniel, this concept can be seen as a metaphorical representation of the journey to self-understanding and personal transformation. The choice to leave Scotomaville (purgatory) and ascend to a higher spiritual plane reflects the idea of realigning skewed perceptions and changing one's given life into the one they envision.



DISCUSS

Share with us a challenge you've overcome, especially the insight others will learn by your example of stepping on something you should not have.



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